

Prague University of Economics and Business

Faculty of Informatics and Statistics



**INTERNATIONAL FILM FESTIVALS AS
INDICATORS OF TRENDS IN FILM
PRODUCTION**

BACHELOR THESIS

Study programme: Multimedia in the Economic Practice

Author: Sofia Permiakova

Bachelor Thesis Supervisor: Ing. Pavel Michalik

Prague, December 2024

Acknowledgement

I owe a huge thank you to my thesis advisor, Ing. Pavel Michalik, for his guidance, patience, and support throughout this work. His insights and encouragement were undoubtedly essential in shaping both the direction and execution of my research.

Abstract

This thesis explores the influence of sociocultural or political agendas on the success of films at international film festivals and their impact on global film production trends. By analysing films awarded at major festivals over the past decade, this study tests two hypotheses: films that are in line with liberal values are more likely to win awards, and such recognition significantly influences global film production. Employing a mix of quantitative and qualitative methods, including thematic analysis and statistical tests, the research examines the prevalence and effects of themes aligned with liberal values in films. The findings indicate that while sociocultural and political themes are common in award-winning films, their presence does not statistically increase the likelihood of winning. Additionally, the themes of award-winning films do not necessarily dictate the thematic direction of global film production. This study contributes to the understanding of the cultural role of film festivals, suggesting that while they showcase relevant sociocultural issues, they do not necessarily determine production trends.

Keywords

International Film Festivals, Political Influence in Cinema, Liberal Values in Film, Global Film Production Trends, Thematic Analysis in Film

Abstrakt

Tato bakalářská práce zkoumá vliv sociokulturních nebo politických agend na úspěch filmů na mezinárodních filmových festivalech a jejich dopad na globální trendy ve filmové produkci. Analýzou filmů oceněných na hlavních festivalech během posledního desetiletí testuje tato studie dvě hypotézy: filmy, které jsou v souladu s liberálními hodnotami, mají větší šanci získat ocenění, a takové uznání významně ovlivňuje globální filmovou produkci. Výzkum, využívající kombinaci kvantitativních a kvalitativních metod, včetně tematické analýzy a statistických testů, zkoumá rozšíření a dopady témat, která jsou v souladu s liberálními hodnotami ve filmech. Zjištění ukazují, že i když jsou sociokulturní a politická témata běžná ve filmech získávajících ocenění, jejich přítomnost statisticky nezvyšuje pravděpodobnost výhry. Navíc témata oceněných filmů nutně nediktují tematický směr globální filmové produkce. Tato studie přispívá k porozumění kulturní roli filmových festivalů, naznačuje, že ačkoliv festivaly prezentují relevantní sociokulturní problémy, nutně neurčují produkční trendy.

Klíčová slova

Mezinárodní filmové festivaly, Politický vliv v kinematografii, Liberální hodnoty ve filmu, Globální trendy filmové produkce, Tematická analýza ve filmu

Contents

Introduction	9
1 Overview of International Film Festivals	11
1.1 Selection of Film Festivals	11
1.2 Historical Background and Significance of Film Festivals	11
2 Trends in Competing Films	13
2.1 Dominant Genres of Films Selected for Festivals	13
2.2 Observed Trends in Selection Factors	15
3. Characteristics of Awarded Films	17
3.1 Understanding of Trends in Awarded Films	17
3.2 Case Study of 2023 Award Winners	18
3.2.1 Overview of Selected Films	18
3.2.2 Qualitative Analysis of Selected Films	18
4 Quantitative Analysis of Award Winners in the Past Decade	20
4.1 Data Definition and Collection	20
4.1.1 Sample Selection	20
4.1.2 Identification of Themes	20
4.1.3 Data Collection and Objectivity of the Analysis	21
4.2 Visualisation and Interpretation of the Results	22
4.2.1 Prominent Themes in Winning Films	22
4.2.2 Change in Theme Frequencies Over Time	23
4.3 Conclusions	24
5 Quantitative Analysis of Competing Films in the last Decade	25
5.1 Data Collection and Objectivity of the Analysis	25
5.2 Visualisation and Interpretation of the Results	25
5.2.1 Prominent Themes in Nominated Films	25
5.2.2 Change in Theme Frequencies Over Time	27

5.3 Conclusions	28
6 Chi-Square Test for Independence	29
7 Correlation Analysis	30
8 Summary of Findings and Reflexion on the Hypotheses	31
8.1 Summary of Findings	31
8.2 Reflexion on the Hypotheses	31
8.2.1 The First Hypothesis	31
8.2.2 The Second Hypothesis	32
8.3 Implications for the Film Industry	32
8.4 Limitations and Future Research	32
Conclusion	33
List of references	34
Appendices	35
Appendix A: Award winners Excel Spreadsheet.....	35
Appendix B: Nominees Excel Spreadsheet	35
Appendix C: Comparison of theme frequencies in nominees against winners Excel Spreadsheet	35
Appendix D: Chi-square test Excel Spreadsheet	35
Appendix E: Correlation analysis Excel Spreadsheet	35

A List of Figures

Fig. 1. Thematic festival space. Panel A 14

Fig. 2. Thematic festival space. Panel B 15

Fig. 3. Theme frequencies in award winners. Bar chart 22

Fig. 4. Theme frequencies in award winners over time. Line chart 23

Fig. 5. Theme frequencies in nominees. Bar chart 26

Fig. 6. Theme frequencies in nominees over time. Line chart 27

A List of Tables

Tab. 1. Percentages of theme occurrences 27

Tab. 2. Contingency table 29

Tab. 3. Correlation analysis data 30

Introduction

Current observations suggest that at international film festivals, the awarding of films may be influenced by factors beyond their quality and artistic values. Often the decision-making on successful films appears to be influenced by their support of certain sociocultural or political agendas. This possibility raises questions about the objectivity of film evaluation at festivals.

This work aims to analyse international film festivals as markers of trends in film production through the examination of competing films, the characteristics of successful films, and the presence of sociocultural and political themes in selected films, which will allow to uncover and understand this trend and its impacts on film production and cultural discourse. The work is relevant to the fields of film studies and cultural analysis and aims to contribute to current research on film festivals and cinematography.

In this work, two main hypotheses are tested:

1. Films that align with liberal values (as defined by themes such as LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity, Ethnic and Racial Minorities, Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment, Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System, and Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights) are more likely to win awards at international film festivals.
2. The recognition at international film festivals significantly influences trends in global film production.

The research methods include comprehensive research of literature related to international film festivals, submitted films, and trends in film production, including the influence of sociocultural and political factors on film production and selection at festivals.

Following the literature review, data is collected. This involves selecting a representative sample of international film festivals, gathering information about awarded and competing films, analysing the characteristics of these films, and assessing how closely the films' narratives align with themes that support a liberal agenda.

As for qualitative analysis, a thematic analysis is conducted to determine the sociocultural and political elements in selected films. This includes case studies of specific films. Thematic elements that support sociocultural or political agendas include but are not limited to: LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity, Ethnic and Racial Minorities, Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment, Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System, and Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights.

To test the hypotheses, a quantitative analysis is conducted. Statistical methods are used to analyse trends in themes and genres (how these trends develop over time) and identify the relationship between trends in competing films and festival winners. Within the frequency analysis, the frequency of each theme across awarded films is measured, as well as the frequency of themes occurring in the years before and after recognition, to see if there is a significant increase after a film with selected themes wins at a festival. Chi-square tests are used to establish a relationship between the presence of these themes and the probability of

winning. Another analysis method is correlation analysis using Pearson correlation coefficients. The correlation between the presence of these themes and the likelihood of winning awards is measured, to assess the relationship between festival recognition and the prevalence of certain themes in global production.

The work begins with an overview of the significance of international film festivals in the film industry and an introduction of the research problem and objectives. Next, the types and genres of films competing in international film festivals are analysed, and trends in factors influencing the selection of films that were chosen to compete in the festivals are identified. Following this, the characteristics of films that have won awards at international film festivals are examined, focusing on common themes, narrative techniques, and styles among awarded films. The next part is a qualitative content analysis of selected films to identify sociocultural and political elements in order to assess the degree of integration of sociocultural and political agendas into films. After that, quantitative analysis (frequency analysis, chi-square test and correlation analysis) is carried out, which provides a basis to reflect on the hypotheses stated at the beginning of the work. The final chapter summarises findings from previous chapters and suggests a discussion on the role of international film festivals as indicators of trends in global film production, providing an understanding of the implications for the global film scene.

1 Overview of International Film Festivals

1.1 Selection of Film Festivals

This work focuses on a selection of five major international film festivals: the Venice Film Festival, Cannes Film Festival, Berlin International Film Festival, Toronto International Film Festival, and International Film Festival Rotterdam. These festivals are chosen due to their global influence, esteemed reputation, diverse selection of films, and the availability of data.

The **Venice Film Festival** is regarded as the first international film festival in history. As the "pioneer" film festival, Venice has brought about a number of firsts for the film industry, including the highly valued Golden Lion award (Britannica, T. Editors of Encyclopaedia, n.d.).

The **Cannes Film Festival** is one of the oldest and most esteemed film festivals globally. It has a long history of setting trends and uncovering emerging talent (Festival de Cannes Official Website, n.d.).

The **Berlin International Film Festival** (also known as Berlinale) is renowned for its diverse selection of films, especially its selection of socially and politically significant films, which is one of the most important aspects of this work. Additionally, the Golden Bear Award is among the most renowned in the film industry, and the festival draws viewers from all over the world (Fehrenbach, 1995).

The **Toronto International Film Festival (TIFF)** is recognised for its role in launching films into the awards season, positioning it as a significant predictor of success at the Oscars. This makes TIFF a critical case study for understanding trends in global film production (TIFF Official Website, n.d.).

The **International Film Festival Rotterdam (IFFR)** is known for its varied programming and strong dedication to avant-garde and non-mainstream films (De Valck, 2007). The relevance of IFFR for this work lies in this festival's ability to illustrate which independent creators have the potential to have their films screened and considered worthy of festival participation.

Collectively, these festivals offer a broad exhibition of films from many cultures and nations, ranging from mainstream to experimental. Each festival has historically played a crucial role in shaping the film industry. Additionally, plenty of data from these festivals is openly accessible, offering an invaluable opportunity for in-depth investigation and analysis.

1.2 Historical Background and Significance of Film Festivals

The concept of showcasing films in a festival format began in Europe in the early 20th century, when Venice hosted the first major international film festival. In this case, we see an example of a political agenda leaving its mark on filmmaking. Under Mussolini's regime, the Venice film festival was considered an effective propaganda tool and was, therefore, encouraged. The initial versions of the festival were characterised by strong fascist

involvement, with awards such as the Mussolini Cup reflecting the regime's power over the festival (Britannica, T. Editors of Encyclopaedia, n.d.). By 1938, the Venice Film Festival had Mussolini's Italy and Hitler's Germany dictating the choices of films and splitting the prizes among themselves. Additionally, in 1940 the festival was renamed the Italian-German Film Festival. (Reich & Garofalo, 2002)

As a response, the Cannes Film Festival was created. According to the official Cannes website, the festival was created to promote cultural exchange and to offer a counterbalance to the Venice Film Festival. Although it was first held in 1946, it was initially scheduled to be held from 1 to 20 September 1939. On September 1, the day of the festival's planned opening, Germany invaded Poland. Two days later, war was declared, and a general mobilisation began, postponing the Cannes until 1946 (Festival de Cannes Official Website, n.d.).

The global film scene expanded in the second half of the 20th century as new festivals appeared on different continents. Founded in 1951, the Berlinale quickly became a symbol of the political and cultural divide between East and West Germany. Western allies, especially the United States, utilised the festival as a platform to push Western democratic ideas and counter Soviet propaganda. The selection of films frequently reflected the geopolitical tensions of the time, emphasising storylines that supported freedom, democracy, and anti-communist narratives (Fehrenbach, 1995).

Today, film festivals are considered essential for promoting films. They serve as a platform for filmmakers to present their work while attracting media attention and gaining critical reviews. This visibility can open new distribution channels and potentially increase box office revenue. Media exposure is one of the ways to elevate a film's status, with journalists and critics attending screenings and writing reviews. As a result, the film becomes more appealing to distributors and audiences (in the case of positive media coverage, of course). Filmmakers can also network with producers, distributors, and other industry experts during festivals, which could result in future partnerships and distribution agreements (De Valck, 2007). Similar observation is expressed by Burgess (2020). The author examines the concept of symbolic value creation at film festivals, highlighting the importance of creating “buzz” around the participating films and its impact on the film industry. The creation of this “buzz” is essential for emerging filmmakers, as it helps to introduce fresh voices into the industry, encouraging innovation and diversity in film production.

2 Trends in Competing Films

2.1 Dominant Genres of Films Selected for Festivals

This work predominantly examines the last decade in film production (starting from the 2010s to the present). Nevertheless, some trends stretch across the whole first quarter of the 21st century, such as the dominance of certain genres in the festival programme.

Dramas are frequent participants at international film festivals, especially those that tackle complex social and personal issues. In this genre, independent films usually rule the competition because of their unique storytelling, which is often motivated by limited budgets (Valck, 2007). According to Marijke de Valck, independent films are essential for fostering fresh perspectives and bringing marginalised stories to light. Recent research confirms that people's interest in thought-provoking material continues, as does these genres' popularity (Zemaityte, Karjus, Rohn, Schich, & Ibrus, 2024).

The same can be observed about documentaries: in the past years, they have seen a rise in popularity for festival selection. Often, these films discuss current global issues, such as social justice or environmental concerns. According to Cindy Hing-Yuk Wong, documentaries are indicative of a trend towards films that explore contemporary issues and tell gripping stories (Wong, 2011). Again, more recent research confirms the persistence of this trend (Zemaityte, Karjus, Rohn, Schich, & Ibrus, 2024).

Quantifying the global film festival circuit: Networks, diversity, and public value creation (Zemaityte, Karjus, Rohn, Schich, & Ibrus, 2024) analyzes the thematic clustering and distribution of films by genre at major international film festivals. In this study, the authors examine how different genres are represented at film festivals and how their popularity and thematic presence change over time. The article covers the time period from 2009 to 2021 and includes data from 616 film festivals and 31,989 films.

The visualisation below color-codes different genres: drama (blue), documentary (yellow), horror (green), thriller (orange), animation (dark blue), LGBT (red), and other (grey).

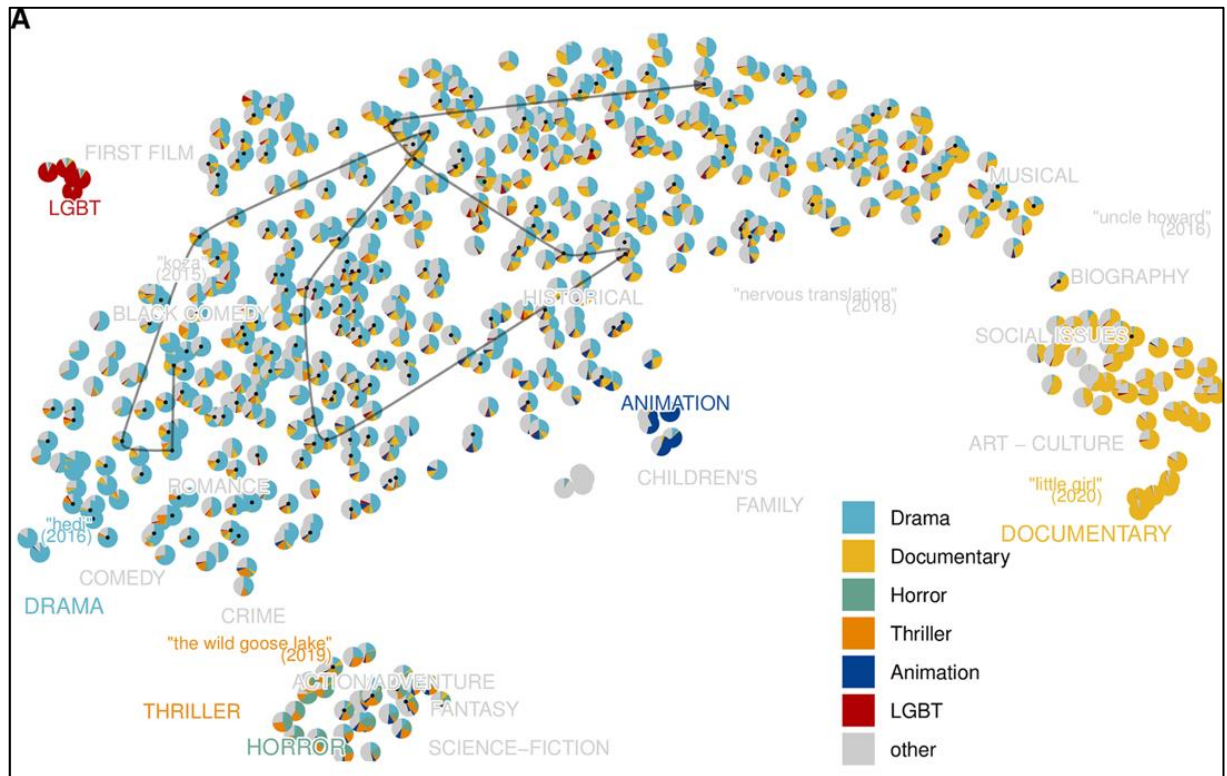


Fig. 1. Thematic festival space. Screenshot of Panel A [Quantifying the global film festival circuit: Networks, diversity, and public value creation (Zemaityte, Karjus, Rohn, Schich, & Ibrus, 2024)] Obtained on the 20.07.2024 from <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0297404>

In panel A, films cluster together based on their genre, indicating common narrative styles and thematic elements. The graph illustrates, that dramas are widespread, often intersecting with other genres. Themes such as social issues, culture, and the arts are prevalent in documentaries. LGBT films form a distinct cluster, highlighting their unique narrative space. Horror and thriller films cluster together, showing a shared audience and thematic content.

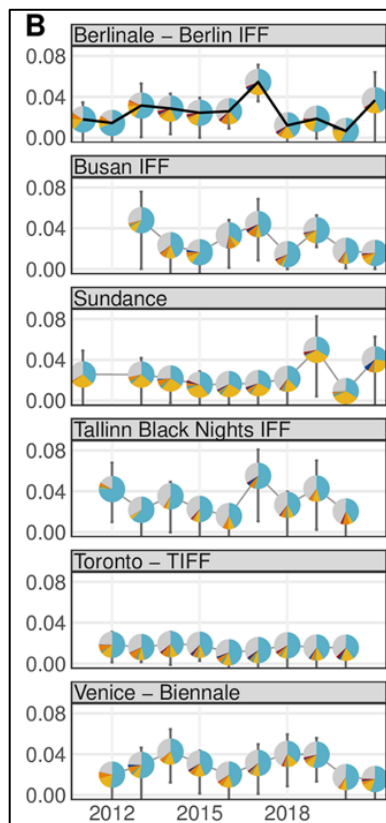


Fig. 2. Thematic festival space. Screenshot of Panel B [Quantifying the global film festival circuit: Networks, diversity, and public value creation (Zemaityte, Karjus, Rohn, Schich, & Ibrus, 2024)] Obtained on the 20.07.2024 from <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0297404>

Panel B shows the frequency of different genres at various film festivals (including Berlin International Film Festival, TIFF, Venice Film Festival) and how they change over time (with the X axis representing the time period and the Y axis representing the coefficient of variability in genre distribution). Berlinale shows more variability in genre distribution compared to others. TIFF, for example maintains relatively stable genre proportions over the years. What can be observed across all festivals is the prevalence of dramas and documentaries during the entire observed period.

The analysis reveals that dramas and documentaries are the most dominant genres, often addressing complex social and personal issues. This dominance emphasises the festivals' significance in promoting films that tackle important contemporary subjects, as well as the audience's continued interest in compelling relevant stories.

2.2 Observed Trends in Selection Factors

UNESCO's publication *Re|Shaping Policies for Creativity – Addressing Culture as a Global Public Good* (2021) provides a valuable insight on what the media field is inclined towards. "Series and films can be used to construct and expand stereotypes and prejudices about those who are different. However, they can also be windows inviting people to get to know each other, thereby helping people shape their self-image and understanding of others. As such, a diverse media system can help bring attention to minority groups, increase mutual understanding and ensure that no one actor or group dominates societal narratives"

(UNESCO, 2021, Chapter 2, p. 71). Another passage from the same article, where the author concludes and provides recommendations for the governments on how to support diversity and inclusion in all parts of the cultural sector, states: "Governments should opt for integrated and flexible policies and implementation plans that remain relevant across the cultural value chain and address transversal challenges for the protection and promotion of the diversity of cultural expressions, such as digital adaptation, gender equality, inclusion and/or climate change" (UNESCO, 2021, Chapter 21, p. 67).

It can be observed that this is inevitably reflected in filmmaking: many films are becoming politically and socioculturally oriented, promoting diversity and raising social issues, because the themes raised in those films are relevant to modern audiences, as well as juries at film festivals.

In keeping with this trend, festivals choose films that showcase diversity in cultural identities, local narratives, and indigenous perspectives, which is in line with the global industry's emphasis on inclusion and representation (Valck, 2007; Wong, 2011). This is also supported by nurturing the talent and skills of artists from developing countries. The Berlinale World Cinema Fund (WCF) is a prominent example. Established in 2004, the WCF assists nations with inadequate film infrastructure, for instance, in Latin America, the Caribbean, Africa, the Middle East, Asia, and the Caucasus. Thirteen projects have received funding since 2016. A few of these have received critical praise and have given African-German co-productions exclusive access to the European market. By making films directed by or starring actors from above-mentioned regions more accessible to European audiences, this effort promotes a wider range of cultural expressions (UNESCO, 2021).

Another festival that this work studies, TIFF, provides platforms specifically for emerging directors, highlighting the support for new filmmakers and the opportunities these festivals create for innovation and diversity in film production (Burgess, 2020).

In summary, dramas, documentaries, and experimental films are prominently featured at film festivals; sociocultural and political themes, innovative storytelling, cultural representation, and the focus on debut filmmakers seem to be key trends influencing film selection. These insights are essential for understanding the role of international film festivals in shaping global film production.

3 Characteristics of Awarded Films

This chapter analyses the characteristics of films that have won awards at international film festivals, by identifying common themes, narrative techniques, and styles among awarded films. First, it provides a general observation and interpretation of trends in award-winning films from the previous decade. Then, the chapter proceeds to analyse these trends by examining 2023 award winners at the selected festivals. The 2023 award winners serve as a contemporary benchmark for understanding current cinematic trends and industry standards. By examining these recent winners, the analysis can highlight how modern storytelling and filmmaking techniques are evolving.

3.1 Understanding of Trends in Awarded Films

Thematic similarities that the awarded films share include raising issues of social justice, human rights, and equality. For instance, *Parasite* (2019) (that won the Palme d'Or – the Cannes Film Festival award) highlights the stark divide between rich and poor in South Korean society, exploring themes of social inequality and economic struggle. Another Palme d'Or holder, *Blue Is the Warmest Color* (2013), explores the intense relationship between two young women and their struggles with identity, love, and societal norms. Winning prestigious awards like the Palme d'Or amplifies the reach and impact of these films, ensuring that their messages find a wider audience. It also validates the filmmakers' efforts in tackling difficult or controversial subjects, encouraging more creators to explore similar themes.

Besides common themes, award-winning films share another similarity: they often use distinctive narrative techniques that set them apart from other competing films. Two Golden Lion Award winners serve as examples here. *Birdman* (2014) is presented as if it were one continuous shot, immersing the viewer in the film's reality. *Nomadland* (2020) blurs the lines between fiction and documentary by casting real nomads alongside professional actors and capturing authentic experiences of life on the road. By starring non-professional actors in this docufiction, the director, Chloé Zhao, made the film stand out from the competition, winning the award at the 2020's Venice Film Festival. These uncommon approaches, while not entirely new, not only resonate with the viewers but also make an impression on film critics and festival juries. As a result, films employing such techniques are often more likely to be recognized and awarded at international film festivals.

Another trend that can be observed is an inclination towards cinematic realism and authenticity. Cuarón's drama *Roma* (2018), which won the Golden Lion at Venice, uses a deeply personal and semi-autobiographical narrative to depict the life of a domestic worker in 1970s Mexico City. The film's use of black-and-white cinematography adds to its nostalgic and intimate feel and allows viewers to focus more on the characters and their stories. It also creates a sense of timelessness and historical accuracy, making the setting feel more authentic. This stylistic choice enhances the emotional depth and realism of the narrative, drawing the audience into the era depicted. *Nomadland* (2020), again, blends fiction with real-life experiences. *Shoplifters* (2018) offers a raw and intimate portrayal of a family living

on the margins of Japanese society, showing the struggles and emotional bonds in a realistic way.

3.2 Case Study of 2023 Award Winners

This section provides key highlights from a thematic analysis done for the award-winning films from 2023. It serves as an example of a thought-process that is done in the research for a larger sample in the following chapters.

3.2.1 Overview of Selected Films

American Fiction (2023) by Cord Jefferson

American Fiction is a Toronto International Film Festival winner. The film explores themes of race and identity through the lens of a black author who struggles with the commercialization of African American culture.

Anatomy of a Fall (2023) by Justine Triet

Anatomy of a Fall, a Cannes Film Festival winner, delves into the complexities of a woman's life as she is put on trial for the murder of her husband.

Poor Things (2023) by Yorgos Lanthimos

Poor Things is a Palme d'Or holder. This Venice Film Festival winner uses a unique narrative style to tell the story of a young woman brought back to life by a scientist, exploring themes of gender equality and personal autonomy.

On the Adamant (2023) by Nicolas Philibert

On the Adamant is a documentary that won 2023's Berlinale. It provides an intimate look at a day care centre for adults with mental disorders, highlighting the importance of compassion and understanding in mental health care.

The Spectre of Boko Haram (2023) by Cyrielle Raingou

The Spectre of Boko Haram gained the Tiger Award at IFFR. The documentary examines the impact of the Boko Haram insurgency on the lives of people in Northern Nigeria, providing a look at the resilience of affected communities.

3.2.2 Qualitative Analysis of Selected Films

Starting with thematic similarities, *American Fiction* and *The Spectre of Boko Haram* are undoubtedly very prominent examples of tackling subjects of race, identity, and social justice. Both address racial issues which is in line with the growing trend in film production and award distribution at film festivals. Another award winner from the sample, *Poor Things*, also addresses social issues. It focuses on gender equality, using a unique narrative to challenge traditional gender roles and highlight issues of personal autonomy and empowerment. Besides, both documentaries, *On the Adamant* and *The Spectre of Boko Haram*, focus on real-world issues and use authentic storytelling to bring attention to important social and political matters.

Interestingly, four out of the five award-winning films fall under the drama or documentary genres, continuing the trend of these genres being not only prominently featured, but also awarded at film festivals.

Among the award-winning films at major international film festivals in 2023, a clear trend toward films that address social issues and employ original narrative techniques can be observed. The festival circuit continues to be dominated by dramas and documentaries, which provide audiences and juries with deep and impactful stories.

4 Quantitative Analysis of Award Winners in the Past Decade

In this chapter, quantitative analysis of award-winning films is described. As the first step, the sample of studied films is defined, as well as the criteria (themes) that allow to measure the liberal agenda's presence in these films. Then, data is collected and organised into a database, where each film gets marked for presence of any of the themes. To determine the themes' presence in the films, a thematic analysis (similar to the case study in Chapter 3.2) is done for each film in the sample. After that, frequencies and percentage of films with selected themes are calculated. These numbers are the basis for the following analysis, that provides insight into how these trends change over time in the studied period and allows to draw conclusions on the significance of these themes' presence for gaining an award.

The chapter does not provide a case study for each film and does not describe each film's storyline and its thematic analysis in detail. Instead, it presents the visualisation of the data obtained in the thematic analysis, the analysis of calculated frequencies and conclusions based on this work.

4.1 Data Definition and Collection

4.1.1 Sample Selection

For this analysis, a sample of 60 award-winning films was selected from the preselected five international film festivals over the past decade (2013–2023). These festivals include previously mentioned the Venice Film Festival, Cannes Film Festival, Berlin International Film Festival, Toronto International Film Festival (TIFF), and International Film Festival Rotterdam (IFFR). The sample size had been expected to be 50 films (5 winners, one for each festival, 10 years), but was adjusted to 60, in respect of the cancellation of the Cannes Film Festival in 2020 due to the COVID-19 pandemic, and larger numbers of winners from 2015, 2014, and 2013 IFFR.

4.1.2 Identification of Themes

The analysis focuses on the frequency of specific "liberal" themes in the selected films, which are typically reflective of progressive cultural values. These themes were chosen based on their prevalence and relevance in modern culture, particularly in films that receive critical acclaim and recognition at film festivals. This selection does not cover all possible ways in which liberal agenda can be present in media. Nevertheless, these themes appear to be most relevant and potentially most common when observing liberal tendencies in modern media. The themes include:

Theme 1: LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity

Films that explore issues related to LGBTQ+ community and sexual orientation. These narratives often challenge traditional norms and highlight the struggles and triumphs of individuals within the LGBTQ+ community.

Theme 2: Ethnic and Racial Minorities

Films that address discrimination against ethnic and racial minorities. These films often bring attention to issues of racism, cultural identity, and the challenges faced by minority groups in society.

Theme 3: Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment

Films that tackle issues related to gender roles, sexism, and the empowerment of women. Often, these films feature either strong female protagonists who challenge “the patriarchy” or women who suffer under oppression in this patriarchal system.

Theme 4: Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System

Films that focus on the disparities between different social classes, often highlighting the lack of access to education and opportunities for the lower class. These narratives often critique the systemic inequalities that perpetuate poverty and social stratification.

Theme 5: Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights

Films that criticize oppressive governments and advocate for individual freedoms and human rights. These films often portray resistance against authoritarian regimes and emphasize the importance of civil liberties.

4.1.3 Data Collection and Objectivity of the Analysis

The themes described above are not necessarily the main storyline in the analysed films but are distinctive and can be identified clearly. For instance, a film might primarily focus on a family drama while also highlighting issues of racial discrimination or gender inequality.

After careful consideration, films dealing with the European immigration crisis were not placed in a separate category. Instead, these films were included under the themes of Ethnic and Racial Minorities (Theme 2) and Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System (Theme 4), as they typically address the intersection of these issues.

In order to analyse the characteristics of the films, I employed a multi-faceted approach. This included reading plot summaries (some films required more detailed storyline examination), watching trailers, and viewing a selection of the films. I also relied on a combination of reliable sources to gather comprehensive information about each film. These sources included IMDb for detailed film data, as well as reviews and articles from reputable news outlets such as The Guardian, The New York Times, and Variety. Additionally, I considered reviews from professional film critics to gain insights into the storylines. This approach allowed me to form a well-rounded understanding of the films' plots and depicted themes.

It is also important to acknowledge that, as with any research, this analysis carries a certain degree of subjectivity. Although it aims to be objective by employing all the appropriate methods, the thematic analysis cannot be done without some degree of the researcher's perspective. This work deals with film and culture, both of which inherently involve

subjective interpretation. The findings, therefore, reflect an effort to balance objective analysis with the recognition that cultural analysis often includes elements of the researcher's interpretation.

4.2 Visualisation and Interpretation of the Results

4.2.1 Prominent Themes in Winning Films

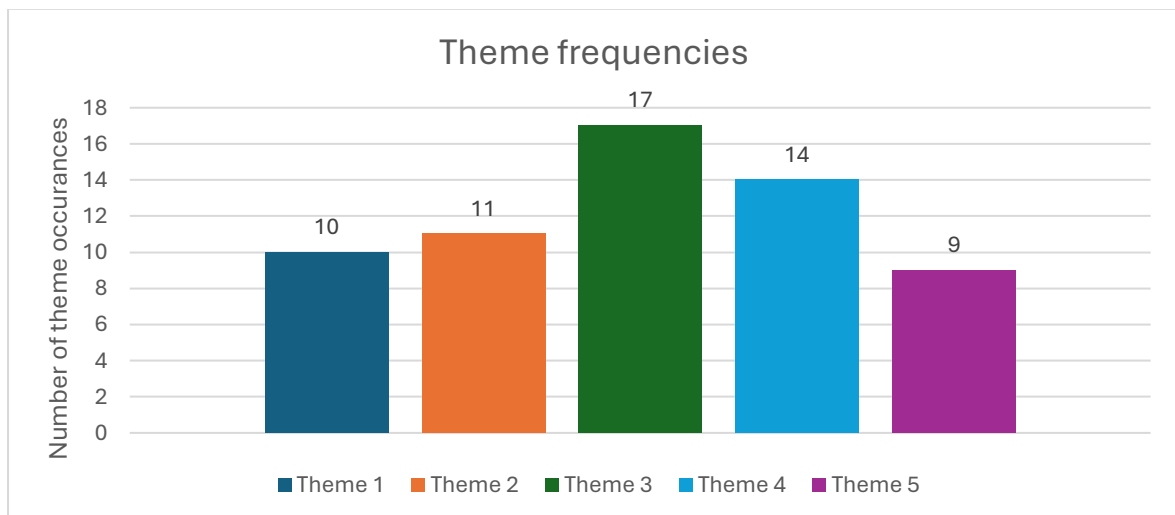


Fig. 3. Theme frequencies in award winners. Bar chart based on frequency data [Award winners Excel Spreadsheet]. (Author's calculations)

Above is a bar chart that visualizes the frequency of each theme among award-winning films at the observed film festivals – Cannes, Venice, TIFF, Berlinale, IFFR from years 2013–2023. Y-axis represents the number of times a theme may occur in the sample, while each bar represents a theme (Theme 1: LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity; Theme 2: Ethnic and Racial Minorities; Theme 3: Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment; Theme 4: Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System; Theme 5: Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights).

Theme 3 (Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment) is the most frequent, occurring 17 times. This suggests that topics related to gender equality and women's empowerment are the most prevalent among the award-winning films.

Theme 4 (Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System) is the next most common, occurring 14 times. This indicates a significant focus on issues of class disparity, which is often explored in cinema, particularly in films critiquing the social order.

Theme 2 (Ethnic and Racial Minorities) with 11 occurrences is followed by **Theme 1 (LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity)** (10 occurrences) and **Theme 5 (Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights)** which appears 9 times, making them the least common among the themes in the dataset.

The chart shows a diverse representation of themes, but it is evident that Theme 3 is more dominant. This may reflect the focus on gender equality in the film industry. The similar

occurrence of Themes 1, 2 and 5 indicates that while all themes are present, films that address gender-related issues are slightly more frequent in the award-winning selection.

4.2.2 Change in Theme Frequencies Over Time

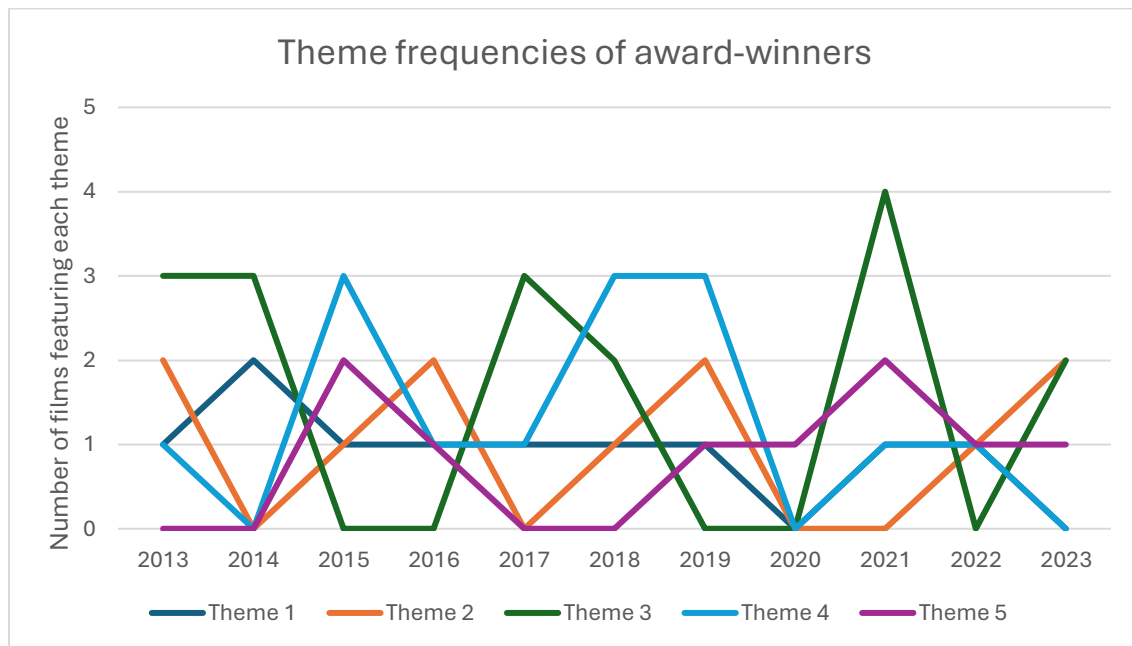


Fig. 4. Theme frequencies in award winners over time. Line chart based on frequency data [Award winners Excel Spreadsheet]. (Author's calculations)

Above is a line chart that visualizes how the frequency of each theme among award-winning films at the observed film festivals (Cannes, Venice, TIFF, Berlinale, IFFR) has changed over time from 2013 to 2023. The X-axis represents the years from 2013 to 2023. The Y-axis represents the number of films featuring each theme (Theme 1: LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity; Theme 2: Ethnic and Racial Minorities; Theme 3: Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment; Theme 4: Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System; Theme 5: Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights).

Theme 1 (LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity) shows a relatively low frequency throughout the years, with peaks only reaching around 2 films in any given year. The theme does not show any significant trend of increase or sustained interest over time, which suggests that while LGBTQ+ themes are present, they have not been a major focus among award-winning films in this dataset.

Theme 2 (Ethnic and Racial Minorities) generally remains lower than themes 3, 4 and 5. It peaks slightly in a few years (2013, 2016, 2019, 2023), where it reaches up to 2 films. This modest presence suggests that racial and ethnic minority narratives appear occasionally but are not consistently emphasized in the sample.

Theme 3 (Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment) is one of the most prominent themes, showing several peaks, in 2017 (likely after the 2017's spike of the "Me Too" movement) and then in 2021, indicating that the topic of gender inequality and women's empowerment has gained attention particularly during those years. It dips

significantly around 2020, likely reflecting a change in film topics recognized during that period.

Theme 4 (Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System) shows high frequency in certain years, especially peaking around 2015, 2018, and 2019, reaching up to 3 films in these years. The frequency drops around 2020 before slightly rising again, showing interest in socioeconomic inequality over several different years.

Theme 5 (Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights) fluctuates significantly, with notable peaks around 2015 and 2021, reaching up to 2 films during these years. The peak in 2015 could indicate a response to the refugee crisis in Europe. Films addressing these issues may have adopted anti-authoritarian themes as a way to critique government policies and advocate for human rights. In 2021, the response to pandemic restrictions, social justice movements, and global political instability may have inspired filmmakers to explore themes that advocate for freedom and critique oppressive systems.

4.3 Conclusions

Themes 3 and 4 (Gender Inequality and Socioeconomic Inequality) are more consistently represented than other themes, possibly reflecting ongoing social conversations around gender equality and economic disparity.

There is a significant dip across multiple themes around 2020, likely reflecting the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on film industry.

The chart overall provides little statistical insight, but rather the ground for suggestions that should be evaluated after collecting data on competing films, to observe patterns and changes in them over time.

A significant proportion of the films analysed—43 out of 60, or 72%—include at least one of the identified themes. Such thematic recognition at festivals could potentially drive filmmakers to include socially relevant content, not only for its impact but also as a strategy to appeal to festival juries. To determine whether this recognition significantly influences the number of films with similar themes that are competing for the main award, the frequency of these themes in the years before and after recognition is measured. The findings are discussed in the following chapter.

5 Quantitative Analysis of Competing Films in the Last Decade

In this chapter, a quantitative analysis is conducted on films that competed for the main awards at major international film festivals over the past decade. The aim of this analysis is to identify the relationship between trends in competing films and festival winners. By observing the frequencies of themes in films nominated in the years before and after a theme-specific film received recognition, the impact this recognition can be examined. This approach helps to determine whether the success of a film with certain themes influences the number of similar films submitted in subsequent years, providing insight into whether such recognition has an impact on selection trends.

5.1 Data Collection and Objectivity of the Analysis

The sample of films used in this analysis is based on IMDb data, focusing on films that were competing for the main awards at the preselected festivals: Cannes, Venice, TIFF, IFFR and Berlin. It is important to mention, that the Toronto International Film Festival (TIFF) does not operate with a single main competition but instead offers the prestigious People's Choice Award, decided by audience votes. Therefore, the sample includes three films for each year – winner, first and second runners-up.

Similarly to the approach in Chapter 4, where the presence of themes in award-winning films was analysed, this chapter presents data visualisation based on a similar table, but now addressing not only films that won the awards, but also those which competed for the awards.

Given the large sample size of 798 films, it was impractical to conduct a detailed manual analysis like the one performed for the 60 winners in the previous chapter. To simplify this process, artificial intelligence (ChatGPT) was used to assist in data collection and preliminary analysis. Specifically, AI was used to identify whether each film fell under one or more of the predefined themes. The AI utilized the latest version of reasoning-based processing (ChatGPT's o1-preview model) to classify films, and the final classification was double-checked and adjusted by me to ensure accuracy.

As 60 out of the 798 films in the sample (award winners) had been manually reviewed, this data could be used to validate the AI's accuracy. The results from Chapter 4 (done completely manually) showed an almost identical match to the AI's categorization, demonstrating both the objectivity of the research and the reliability of the AI's data. This approach allowed for efficient data collection while maintaining the integrity and accuracy of the analysis.

5.2 Visualisation and Interpretation of the Results

5.2.1 Prominent Themes in Nominated Films

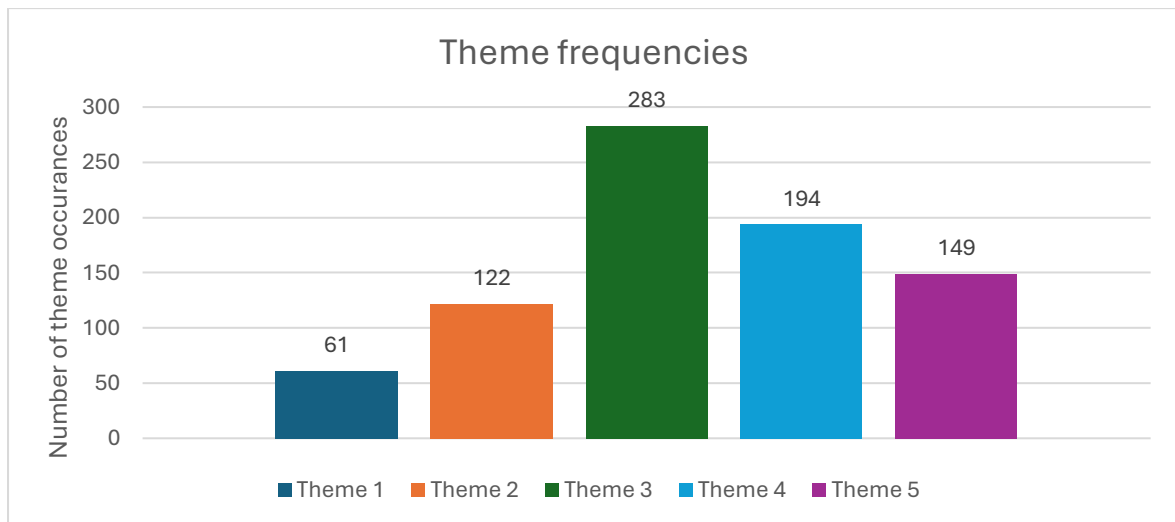


Fig. 5. Theme frequencies in nominees. Bar chart based on frequency data [Nominees Excel Spreadsheet]. (Author's calculations)

Above is a bar chart that visualizes the frequency of each theme among the films competing for the main award at the observed film festivals – Cannes, Venice, TIFF, Berlinale, IFFR from years 2013–2023. Y-axis represents the number of times a theme may occur in the sample, while each bar represents a theme (Theme 1: LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity; Theme 2: Ethnic and Racial Minorities; Theme 3: Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment; Theme 4: Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System; Theme 5: Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights).

With 283 occurrences, **Theme 3 (Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment)** is the most prevalent theme among nominees, far surpassing the other themes. Compared to the chart based on award winners in Chapter 4, Theme 3 is also dominant among nominees, indicating consistency in its importance. However, it appears that this theme is slightly more frequently nominated than it is awarded (35% of the nominees sample against 28% of the winners sample), hinting that while gender inequality is a prominent theme, it may not always secure the main prize.

Theme 4 (Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System) follows as the second most common theme, with 194 occurrences. This high frequency aligns with the trend seen in winners, with Theme 4 representing 23% of the winners' sample compared to 24% of nominees sample.

With 149 occurrences, **Theme 5 (Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights)** ranks third among the themes. This frequency is higher among nominees than winners (19% for nominees, 15% for winners), which might imply that while such themes are appreciated, they might be slightly less favoured when it comes to final awards.

Theme 2 (Ethnic and Racial Minorities) has 122 occurrences, showing a moderate level of representation among nominees. This suggests an interest in films addressing racial and ethnic issues, though it appears less central than gender or socioeconomic themes. In contrast with Themes 3 and 5, Theme 2 shows a different winner–nominee ratio. Theme 2

represents a smaller part of the nominees' sample (15%) than winners' sample (18%), implying that it is more favourable in the eyes of juries when it comes to awarding the prize.

Theme 1 (LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity) is the least frequent, with 61 occurrences. With this relatively low frequency Theme 1 represents 8% of the nominees, while covering 17% of the winners' sample, suggesting similar pattern as Theme 2.

The table below provides an overview of the percentage of theme occurrences in films at the observed film festivals – Cannes, Venice, TIFF, Berlinale, IFFR from years 2013–2023, where one row contains data for nominees, another row – for winners. The columns represent 5 themes (Theme 1: LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity; Theme 2: Ethnic and Racial Minorities; Theme 3: Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment; Theme 4: Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System; Theme 5: Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights), while the last column provides percentages of films in the sample that include at least one of the identified themes.

	Theme 1	Theme 2	Theme 3	Theme 4	Theme 5	total
Nominated	8%	15%	35%	24%	19%	69%
Won	17%	18%	28%	23%	15%	72%

Tab. 1. Percentages of theme occurrences. [Comparison of theme frequencies in nominees against winners Excel Spreadsheet]. (Author's calculations)

5.2.2 Change in Theme Frequencies Over Time

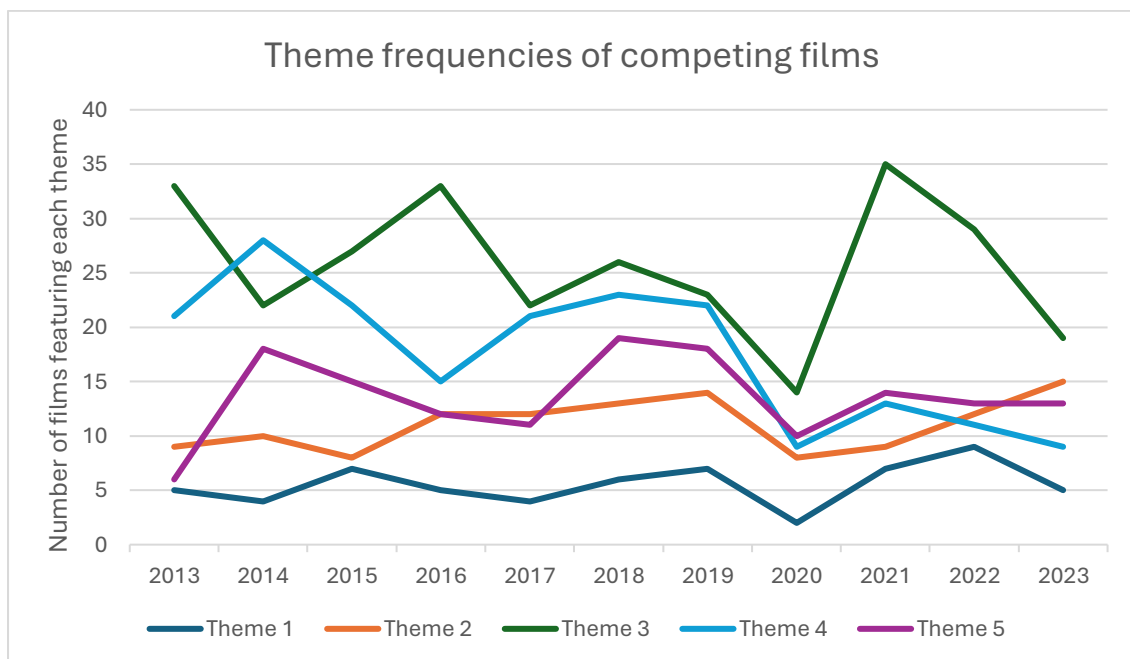


Fig. 6. Theme frequencies in nominees over time. Line chart based on frequency data [Nominees Excel Spreadsheet]. (Author's calculations)

Above is a line chart that visualizes how the frequency of each theme among the films competing for the main award at the observed film festivals (Cannes, Venice, TIFF, Berlinale, IFFR) has changed over time from 2013 to 2023. The X-axis represents the years

from 2013 to 2023. The Y-axis represents the number of films featuring each theme (Theme 1: LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity; Theme 2: Ethnic and Racial Minorities; Theme 3: Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment; Theme 4: Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System; Theme 5: Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights).

Theme 1 (LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity) and **Theme 2 (Ethnic and Racial Minorities)** show a relatively steady, moderate frequency over time with minor peaks (Theme 1 around 2015, 2019 and 2022; Theme 2 around 2014, 2019 and 2023). This indicates sustained but less prominent interest in films addressing LGBTQ+ issues, as well as racial and ethnic issues.

Theme 3 (Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment) shows sustained prominence over time, with peaks in 2013, 2016, and 2021. This indicates consistent interest in gender-related themes. The steady presence of Theme 3 aligns with its dominance among winners, further confirming that gender equality is a central focus for both nominees and winners in film festivals.

Theme 4 (Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System) has several peaks, particularly in 2014, 2018 and in 2021, after the 2020 dip. Its frequency shows a gradual decrease, especially after 2019, suggesting a decrease in relevance of this theme.

Theme 5 (Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights) shows noticeable peaks, especially in 2014, 2018 and 2021, possibly in response to global political movements or increased attention to authoritarian issues. There are noticeable similarities between Theme 4 and Theme 5 patterns, with peaks in the same years, however, after 2021 Theme 5 (previously less represented than Theme 4) begins to be more dominant than Theme 4.

5.3 Conclusions

In conclusion, the charts reveal that festival nominees align closely with winners in thematic focus, with gender and socioeconomic issues as dominant themes. However, nominees include a broader representation of anti-authoritarian theme, which is often present in competing films but not always awarded. Interestingly, Theme 1 (LGBTQ+ issues) represents a significantly smaller part of the nominees' sample (8%) than winners' sample (17%), suggesting that the films that raise these issues are more likely to win the award.

Generally, there is no clear, immediate increase in the frequency of themes among nominees following a win. This suggests that a single theme win does not significantly influence the types of themes in subsequent nominated films. Festivals appear to favour specific themes consistently, rather than adjusting selections based on the themes of previous winners. To prove this, correlation analysis is done in the Chapter 7.

6 Chi-Square Test for Independence

To test if the presence of the themes significantly influences the chances of a film winning an award, a relationship between the presence of these themes and the probability of winning needs to be established. In order to do so, chi-square test was performed. Below is a contingency table where one dimension is the presence or absence of the themes, and the other dimension is whether the film won or not.

	Theme present	Theme not present	Total
Won	43	17	60
Not won	508	230	738
Total	551	247	798

Tab. 2. Contingency table. [Chi-square test Excel Spreadsheet]. (Author's calculations)

After calculating the expected frequency values, chi-square statistic value and p-value, the obtained result of the p-value was 0,976250003. A p-value below 0.05 indicates a statistically significant result, suggesting that the correlation observed is unlikely due to random variation. A p-value above 0.05 suggests that the correlation may be due to random chance and not statistically significant.

In this case, a p-value of 0,976250003 (≥ 0.05), indicates no significant association between the presence of themes and winning an award. This means, that although the high presence of "liberal" themes in the award-winning sample (72% of films in the sample marked positive for at least one theme) seemingly influences the film's chances to be awarded, the association is likely due to random variation rather than a true causal link between having a theme and winning an award.

The chi-square test proves that the apparent relationship between the presence of themes and winning an award is not statistically significant. This suggests that even though many winners include themes, their presence is not a reliable predictor of winning.

7 Correlation Analysis

Observations from Chapter 5 suggest that there is no obvious increase in the frequency of themes among nominees following a win. This led to the assumption that a single theme's win does not significantly influence the prevalence of that theme in subsequent nominated films. Instead, festivals appear to favour certain themes consistently over time, suggesting a stable thematic preference. To substantiate this claim, a correlation analysis was conducted to examine the relationship between the frequency of each theme among nominees and its corresponding frequency among winners.

The Pearson correlation coefficient was used to assess the linear relationship between the frequency of each theme among nominees and its frequency among winners. Pearson's correlation coefficient ranges from -1 to +1, where +1 indicates a perfect positive linear relationship; 0 indicates no linear relationship; -1 indicates a perfect negative linear relationship.

For each theme, the correlation coefficient was calculated, along with the t-statistic and p-value to determine the statistical significance of the observed correlation. Below are the results of the correlation analysis for each theme:

	THEME 1	THEME 2	THEME 3	THEME 4	THEME 5
PEARSON CORRELATION	0,24625914	0,50670657	0,23133577	0,45546745	0,07173642
DEGREE OF FREEDOM	9	9	9	9	9
T-STATISTIC	0,76225171	1,76323735	0,71335788	1,53484821	0,21576517
P-VALUE	0,46541636	0,11169105	0,49370552	0,15919231	0,83398145

Tab. 3. Correlation analysis data. [Correlation analysis Excel Spreadsheet]. (Author's calculations)

The results indicate that none of the themes have a statistically significant correlation between their frequency in nominees and their frequency in winners, as all p-values are above the 0.05 threshold. Theme 2 shows the highest correlation among the themes, but with a p-value above 0.05, it is still not statistically significant. This implies that the frequency of ethnic and racial minority themes among nominees and winners is not meaningfully related, further supporting the observation that nomination trends do not shift significantly based on prior wins.

These results reinforce the conclusion that festivals exhibit stable thematic preferences, without a vast shift following a theme's win.

8 Summary of Findings and Reflexion on the Hypotheses

The final chapter provides a summary of findings from previous chapters and discusses the role of international film festivals as indicators of trends in global film production, providing an understanding of the implications for the global film scene.

8.1 Summary of Findings

The findings of this study indicate that while certain themes are common among award-winning films, there is no significant evidence that aligning with liberal values guarantees a film's success at international film festivals. Although the predefined "liberal" themes are frequently found in award winners, this prevalence does not appear to directly influence jury decisions in a systematic way.

Similarly, the analysis revealed that a single theme win does not significantly influence the types of themes in nominated films in subsequent years. While certain themes may gain temporary attention, there is no significant long-term impact on the types of films being produced and nominated in following years. The absence of a clear pattern suggests that filmmakers may not necessarily follow the thematic successes of previous winners when deciding on their projects' narratives.

8.2 Reflexion on the Hypotheses

8.2.1 The First Hypothesis

Films that align with liberal values (as defined by themes such as LGBTQ+ and Sexual Identity, Ethnic and Racial Minorities, Gender Inequality and Women's Empowerment, Socioeconomic Inequality and Class System, and Anti-Authoritarianism and Advocacy for Freedom and Human Rights) are more likely to win awards at international film festivals.

Thematic analysis in Chapter 4 revealed that 72% of the award winners in the last decade contained at least one of the predefined "liberal" themes. Chi-square test in Chapter 6 allowed to determine whether there is a significant association between the presence of these themes and winning awards. Despite the high presence of themes among winners, their presence does not significantly influence the chances of winning. The high prevalence of themes likely reflects broader trends in festival nominations rather than a direct correlation with winning outcomes. Thus, the presence of themes is a descriptive feature of the dataset, not a predictive factor for success.

This suggests that although the themes are relevant to the juries, no proof was found that the presence of "liberal agenda" significantly influences the film's chances of winning.

Thus, the hypothesis was disproved.

8.2.2 The Second Hypothesis

The recognition at international film festivals significantly influences trends in global film production.

In Chapter 5 it is observed that there is no clear increase in the frequency of themes among nominees following a win. Festivals do not appear to adjust selections based on the themes of previous winners. Correlation analysis in Chapter 7 further proves this. The results indicate festivals show consistent thematic preferences without a significant change after a theme wins.

Thus, the hypothesis was disproved.

8.3 Implications for the Film Industry

These findings provide ground for understanding the role of international film festivals in shaping global film production. The results suggest that while festivals provide a platform for highlighting socially relevant themes, they do not necessarily dictate future production trends theme-wise. Instead, they often reflect cultural and social context in which films are produced and recognized.

Furthermore, festivals seem to serve as a platform where diverse voices and themes are brought to light, without directly influencing future industry practices. This suggests that filmmakers tend to choose themes based on a variety of influences beyond festival trends.

8.4 Limitations and Future Research

It is important to acknowledge the limitations of this study. The analysis is focused on a specific set of festivals and a limited range of themes, which may not capture the full complexity of factors influencing both festival outcomes and global production trends. Additionally, reliance on AI-based preliminary analysis, while efficient, may introduce biases or inaccuracies that could affect the results. Further bias is associated with the researcher's perspective in the thematic analysis. It is essential to keep in mind that this work deals with film and culture, two areas which inherently involve subjective interpretation, even though the research attempts to be objective by using relevant approaches. Therefore, the results show an effort to find a balance between objective analysis and the understanding that cultural analysis frequently incorporates aspects of the researcher's interpretation.

Future research could expand on these findings by including a broader range of festivals and examining other factors that may contribute to a film's success. Additionally, qualitative research could involve interviews with festival juries or filmmakers to provide deeper insights into the decision-making processes behind festival selections.

Conclusion

This work has critically examined the extent to which international film festivals influence broader trends in global film production, particularly through the lens of sociocultural and political themes. The work was structured around two hypotheses: firstly, that films aligning with liberal values are more likely to win awards, and secondly, that such recognition significantly influences subsequent global film production trends.

The findings reveal that while sociocultural and political themes are very common in award-winning films, their presence does not statistically increase the likelihood of winning. Moreover, the analysis has shown that the thematic focus of award-winning films does not necessarily shape the thematic direction of global film production. This suggests that while film festivals serve as important platforms for showcasing films that engage with current sociocultural and political themes, they do not dictate the production trends in the film industry.

Throughout the research, it became clear that film festivals continue to reflect the cultural context, highlighting issues that resonate with contemporary audiences and critics. However, the hypothesis that festivals significantly impact global production trends based on the themes of winning films was not supported. Therefore, both hypotheses were disproved.

Future research could explore further the role of festival recognition in shaping film production trends. Additionally, it would be beneficial to examine a broader range of festivals and consider other factors that could contribute to a film's success.

In conclusion, while film festivals play a crucial role in the cultural landscape by reflecting current societal issues and values, they are less influential as trendsetters in global film production than previously thought. This thesis contributes to an understanding of the cultural significance of film festivals and their impact on film production, offering a foundation for future studies in this field.

List of references

Britannica, T. Editors of Encyclopaedia. (n.d.). Venice Film Festival. Encyclopedia Britannica. Retrieved July 23, 2024, from <https://www.britannica.com/art/Venice-Film-Festival>

Burgess, D. (2020). Capturing Film Festival Buzz: The Methodological Dilemma of Measuring Symbolic Value.

Fehrenbach, H. (1995). Cinema in Democratizing Germany: Reconstructing National Identity After Hitler. Chapel Hill, NC: University of North Carolina Press.

Festival de Cannes. (2023). History of the Festival. Festival de Cannes. Retrieved August 1, 2024, from <https://www.festival-cannes.com/en/festival/films/history>

IMDb. (n.d.). In the Internet Movie Database. Retrieved October 15, 2024, from <https://www.imdb.com>

Reich, J., & Garofalo, P. (Eds.). (2002). Re-viewing Fascism: Italian Cinema, 1922-1943. Indiana University Press. Retrieved July 15, 2024, from <https://doi.org/10.2307/j.ctt2005t72>

Toronto International Film Festival. (n.d.). Mission & vision. Retrieved August 1, 2024, from <https://www.tiff.net/about-us/mission-vision>

UNESCO. (2021). Re|Shaping policies for creativity – Addressing culture as a global public good. UNESCO Publishing. Retrieved July 20, 2024, from <https://en.unesco.org/creativity/publications/periodicreports>

Valck, M. de. (2007). Film Festivals: From European Geopolitics to Global Cinephilia. Amsterdam: Amsterdam University Press (Film Culture in Transition).

Wong, C. H.-Y. (2011). Film Festivals: Culture, People, and Power on the Global Screen. New Brunswick, NJ: Rutgers University Press.

Zemaityte, V., Karjus, A., Rohn, U., Schich, M., & Ibrus, I. (2024). Quantifying the global film festival circuit: Networks, diversity, and public value creation. PLOS ONE, 19(3), e0297404. Retrieved July 20, 2024, from <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0297404>

Appendices

All appendices are available in the links below for OneDrive users from the University of Economics and Business. Additionally, each Excel file is uploaded as an external appendix.

Appendix A: Award winners Excel Spreadsheet

https://vse-my.sharepoint.com/:x:/g/personal/perso4_vse_cz/EbvkdZ1VFRFGhSZ9eodUclQBLomjVnIgwGSUUITFL_w6vg?e=RaHr5c

Appendix B: Nominees Excel Spreadsheet

https://vse-my.sharepoint.com/:x:/g/prsonal/perso4_vse_cz/Ede1omwes_9JvWjNODUnl-cB_r2ZA6EPTreX3U2jRXbRnQ?e=f6K2va

Appendix C: Comparison of theme frequencies in nominees against winners Excel Spreadsheet

https://vse-my.sharepoint.com/:x:/g/personal/perso4_vse_cz/EVqwBPtXRn1ChyCnjijwKTsBrvR-GveXdfZtN1KO3_KS8w?e=gxSr9y

Appendix D: Chi-square test Excel Spreadsheet

https://vse-my.sharepoint.com/:x:/g/personal/perso4_vse_cz/EX119DpFmapBlbolOIMoqVMBBfze_8V_GkwcViBnzYExOw?e=YG4tf5

Appendix E: Correlation analysis Excel Spreadsheet

https://vse-my.sharepoint.com/:x:/g/personal/perso4_vse_cz/EQ-qI1S9IiBNpLxZHZ2WaFEBcHKrGTZ9sm4yvvhx18z5sXA?e=sPYcxY